

A close-up photograph of a hand pulling a wooden block from a Jenga tower. The tower is made of light-colored wooden blocks stacked in a traditional pattern. The hand is positioned on the left side of the frame, with the thumb and index finger gripping the block. The background is a soft, out-of-focus light blue.

YOU ARE HERE
ON THE TRADITIONAL
TERRITORY OF THE
HAUDENOSAUNEE,
ANISHNAWBE AND
NEUTRAL
PEOPLES.

WHAT **YOU** DO HERE...
COUNTS OUT THERE®

Decision Making, Reliability & Creativity

**CDEV 1520: Understanding
Workplace Behaviours**

Today's Topics

Decision Making & Creativity

Apply the rational decision-making model.

Recognize the role of emotions, biases and errors in decision-making.

Discuss critical timelines and the impact of missed deadlines.

Discuss tools and resources for handling failure.

Discuss growth versus fixed mindset.

Discuss creative thinking and the role of curiosity in the workplace.

Reliability

Discuss the impact on punctuality, meeting deadlines, and critical timelines.

Explore time management skills, tools and resources for effective time management.

Discuss productivity and how it impacts success.

Discuss the term “what needs to be done, what can I do?”, proactiveness, and integration as a new employee

Decision Making

- How do you make a decision?
- What strategies do you use?
When? Why?
- Is it important?
- What is the value of good decision making skills in the workplace?

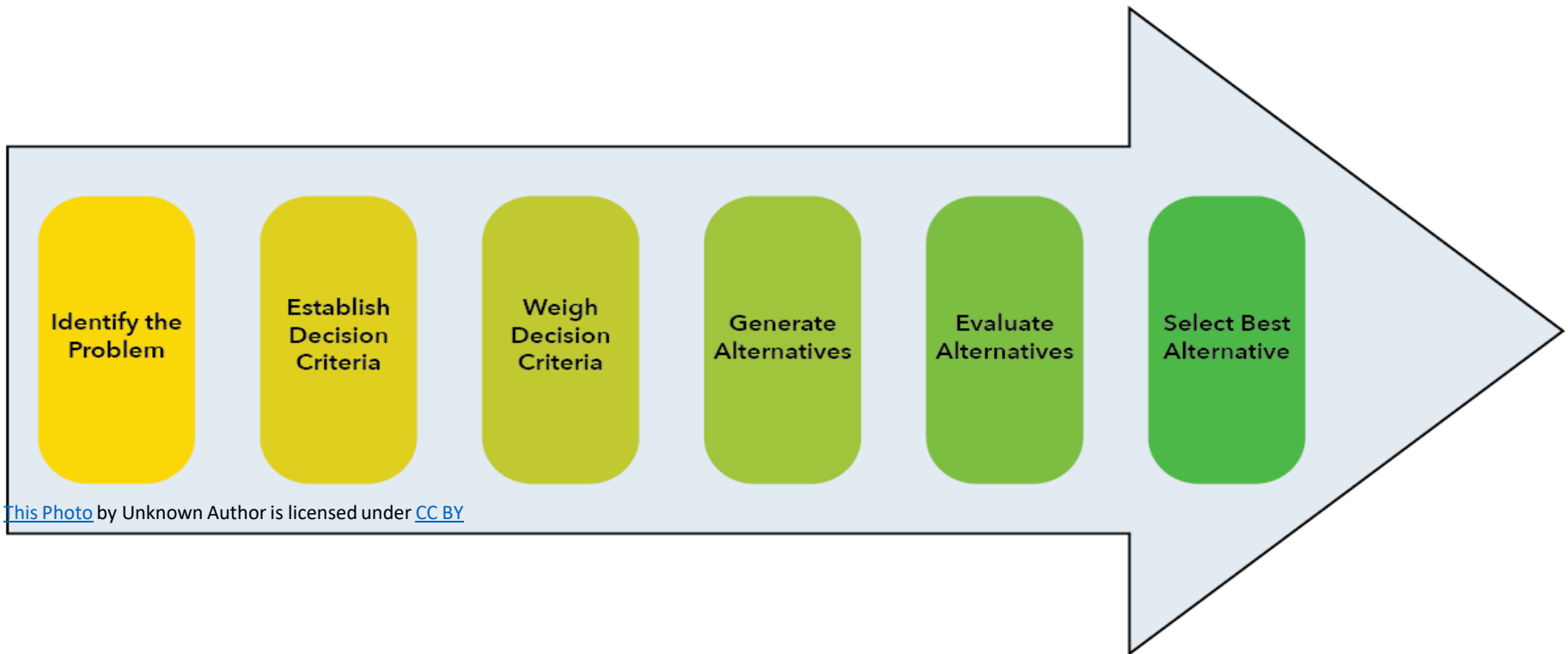
The Rational Decision Making Process



[The Rational Decision Making Model: Steps and Purpose in Organizations](#)

RDM model for problem-solving

The Rational Decision-Making Process



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1. Identify the Problem

**Identify the problem and level of importance.
Determine your desired outcome.**



- Jane's manager expects her to complete a client's website by the end of the week. The client keeps calling and changing the content and design. Jane is not able to meet the deadline with all the changes the client is making and she is not comfortable setting expectations with the client.
- What is/are the problem(s)?

2. Establish Decision Criteria

Relevant information? What variables can impact the outcome?



- Jane reviews the client's contract and the costs for all the changes resulting in delays.
- Jane discusses the situation with her manager and explains all the delays.
- Jane can stay late to complete the most recent changes, but it requires overtime.
- Strategies to deal with discomfort with confronting the client.

3. Weigh Decision Criteria

Rank the decision criteria.

- Contract billed the client for a set fee to build the website based on established content and design with the client
- The contract is clear that changes may result in additional fees
- Jane is scheduled to work on a new client project the following week so she would need to work overtime to complete the changes

What decisions can be considered?



4. Generate Alternatives

Create a list of options.



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What are the options?

- Ask manager to speak to the client about expectations and added costs for changes
- Make changes and bill client / or do not bill client
- Ask to work overtime to complete the changes at an added cost for overtime
- Ask manager to assign new project to another team member so Jane can work on it the following week
- Ask for coaching on setting firm expectations with the client and communicating the impact and cost of changes

5. Evaluate Alternatives

Consider the alternatives and weigh the options.



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What option would you pick?

- Manager speaks to the client about expectations and added costs for changes
- Jane speaks to client about expectations and added costs for changes
- Make changes and bill client or do not bill client
- Make changes and incur the costs of Jane working overtime
- Make changes and assign new project to another team member so Jane can work on it the following week
- Jane asks for coaching on setting firm expectations with the client
- What is the impact on the client relationship?
- What other alternatives could be considered?

6. Select Best Alternative

Choose the best option and finalize your decision..



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What option would you pick?

How to Make Better Decisions



Are You Reliable?



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What is reliability
and how does it
impact your
reputation?
The business?



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What does
productivity mean to
you?
To your employer?



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How does
productivity impact
success?

What needs to be done, what can I do?

Time Management

*Common Interview Question

TASK 1
TASK 2
TASK 3
TASK 4

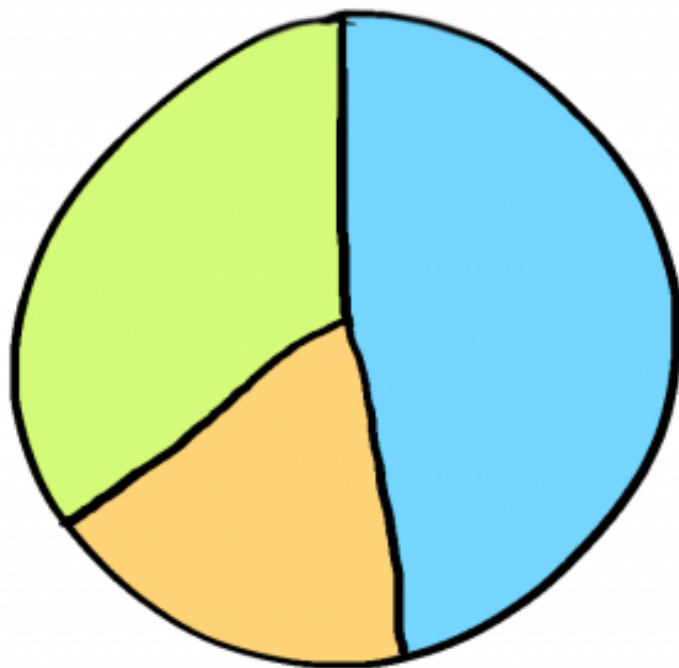


"This role has a lot of new and competing priorities....

How do you manage your time and prioritize so tasks and projects are completed on time?"

Overcoming the Imposter Syndrome | astrobites

<https://astrobites.org/2018/03/02/overcoming-the-imposter-syndrome/>



-  PEOPLE WHO GET IMPOSTER SYNDROME
-  OTHER PEOPLE WHO GET IMPOSTER SYNDROME
-  LITERALLY EVERYONE ELSE (THEY ALSO GET IMPOSTER SYNDROME)

EVERYONE FEELS LIKE AN IMPOSTER
SOMETIMES, AND THAT'S OKAY

I'm an imposter?!

What is Imposter Syndrome and How Do You Overcome it?

<https://www.freecodecamp.org/news/what-is-imposter-syndrome-and-how-do-you-overcome-it/>



- “What am I doing here?”
- “I am not a developer. I am fooling myself and other people.” (feels fake)
- “My colleagues are much smarter than I am; I could never match up to them.” (undermines own achievements)
- “My coworkers have told me I’ve achieved a lot, but I feel like it’s never enough.” (discounts praise)
- “I have no idea how I got through the interview process.” (feels only luck dictates results)
- “I will be ridiculed and fired when people realize I am not as smart as I portrayed myself as being.” (fears failure)
- “My IQ is not high enough to work here.” (doubts inherent ability)
- “I need more training to feel like I deserve to be here.”

How to.... Solve Imposter Syndrome

=

GROWTH MINDSET



What's your MINDSET?

FIXED MINDSET VS GROWTH MINDSET

GROWTH vs. FIXED

Intelligence is something you HAVE OR DON'T HAVE

With a **FIXED** mindset
we tend to:

- Avoid taking on challenges
- Quit or give up easily
- Be highly self-critical
- See effort as pointless
- Disregard criticism
- Resent the success of others
- Criticise and judge others
- Argue for our limitations

Intelligence is something you ARE ABLE TO DEVELOP

With a **GROWTH** mindset
we tend to:

- Embrace any challenge
- Never give up
- Practice self-compassion
- See effort as a journey
- Learn from all criticism
- Be inspired by others' success
- Help and nurture others
- Believe in possibilities

Creative vs. Critical Thinking

Critical thinking is the ability to clearly and logically consider information that is presented to us.

Creative thinking is about generating new, novel, or useful ideas.

<https://www.linkedin.com/pulse/creative-thinking-vs-critical-james-taylor#>

Creative Thinking

Generating

Ideas

Intuitive

Unusual

Unique

Critical Thinking

Focusing

Analyze

Logical

Comparing

Judging



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Creative & Critical Thinking

James Taylor - <https://www.jamestaylor.me/creative-thinking-vs-critical-thinking/>





Strengths - What are the strengths of creative and/or critical thinking? Is there a better time to use one over the other?



Weaknesses - What are the weaknesses of creative and/or critical thinking? Have you used one style in a situation when maybe the other would have been better?



Opportunities - What opportunities might present when using creative and/or critical thinking in the workplace?



Threats - What treats do your think might arise when using creative and/or critical thinking?

In Class Graded Case Study 1

You have just been hired by a small software consultancy company as a web developer. It is a small company with 8 employees. There are only 3 technical people on staff. You have been on the job for 3 weeks and have been working closely with your mentor that was assigned to you.

You are working on your first project for a client and at the start of your 4th week, you run into a problem. When you reach out to your mentor, you receive an out-of-office reply that they are away and have not given any return date. You are stuck and do not know how to proceed with the project.

What would you do if you were in this situation? How would you keep the project moving along?

Include any assumptions that you are making with your answer.

In Class Graded Case Study 2

- You are excited about your new job at a start-up with a great reputation for excellent workplace culture. Not long into your venture, you encountered a problem where you are assigned a section of a project that is very unfamiliar to you in its scope and involves multiple technologies that you were not exposed to in school. It is evident that you needed to accomplish this task independently. While it's a fun place to work, you find that start-up culture means things move fast, and other members of the team have other responsibilities, and you feel they may not have time to support you.
- **What do you do?**



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Resources

- [Rational Decision Making: The 7-Step Process for Making Logical Decisions](#)
- [Learn FASTER and become a PRODUCTIVE developer with a pyramid of skills](#)
- [Spark: REACHING YOUR POTENTIAL – FIXED VS GROWTH MINDSET](#)
- [11 Growth Mindset Strategies: Overcome Your Fix Mindset to Grow as a Person](#)
- [4 Steps to a developing a Growth Mindset](#)
- [TED – Carol Dweck: The power of believing that you can improve](#)
- [How to get better at receiving feedback](#)
- [Creative thinking - how to get out of the box and generate ideas: Giovanni Corazza at TEDxRoma](#)
- [The 6 Habits of Exceptionally Creative People](#)
- [The benefits of a good night's sleep](#) - Shai Marcu
- [Common Biases and Judgment Errors in Decision Making Organizational Behavior](#) (by Jennifer Lombardo)
- [How to Plan Your Week Effectively](#)
- [These Skills Are Hard To Learn But Pay Off For The Rest of Your Life](#)
- [Why Most People Will Remain in Mediocrity](#)
- [4 Ways To Be 10x More Productive In 2022](#)
- Free book download: [How to Be More Productive](#)
- [How to NOT GET FIRED in your first programming job!](#)
- [The psychology behind irrational decisions](#) - Sara Garofalo